

Programme Guideline

Handbook, weekly deliverables, roles, submission rules and ground rules in one place

Client	Generation Bridge Foundation
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1. Welcome to the engagement

Your team has been retained as external strategy consultants by the Board of Generation Bridge Foundation (GBF), a Vietnamese non-profit working on youth unemployment. The engagement runs from Sunday 26 July to Sunday 20 September 2026 (eight working weeks, Monday to Friday). You will diagnose a genuine strategic problem, test your thinking against incomplete evidence, and present a recommendation to the Board.

This is a simulated but realistic engagement. There is no single correct answer. You will be assessed on the quality of your thinking, the honesty of your evidence, the discipline of your teamwork, and the clarity of your communication.

Generation Bridge Foundation, VPBank Foundation (as portrayed here), named staff, beneficiaries and employers are fictional constructs created for the Momentum Impact Case. They do not represent real organisations or people. Do not import outside data, news or personal knowledge into deliverables or inferences.

2. The client at a glance

Item	Detail
Organisation	Generation Bridge Foundation (Cau Noi The He) - fictional case client
Founded	2014, Ho Chi Minh City
Mission	Connect 16-24 year-olds who are not in education, employment or training (NEET) to dignified work
2025 budget	VND 18.2 billion
Young people served in 2025	800
Current waitlist (Jan 2026)	1,100
Staff	67 full-time, 12 part-time, ~340 active volunteers
Delivery hubs	Ho Chi Minh City (2), Binh Duong (1), Dong Nai (1), Long An (pilot)

3. Why you have been retained

The Board meets on Thursday 10 September 2026 to set GBF's direction for the next three years. Members do not agree. A major funder decision is on the table. Field staff and young people are describing problems that do not appear cleanly in the public materials. You have been retained to prepare a recommendation the Board can adopt - with options, evidence, and an honest view of trade-offs.

"We need a decision we can live with, not a slide that papers over our disagreements. Tell us what you would do in our place, and why."

- Engagement letter from the GBF Board, 15 January 2026

The engagement letter does not hand you a finished problem statement. Framing what the Board is really deciding - and what is noise - is part of the work (deliverable A1). Read the client data room carefully: senior staff, the largest donor and individual board members pull in

different directions. Some of what you are told will not survive contact with the operational record held by Workflow B.

4. How your team is organised: two workflows

Every team of five or six splits into two consulting workflows. The split is deliberate. Each workflow holds incomplete information. You must talk to each other to converge. Read both engagement briefs.

Workflow	Owns	Folder
A - Impact Strategy	Problem framing, stakeholder synthesis, the questions worth asking, strategic options, and the Board narrative	2_Workflow_A_Impact_Strategy
B - Operations & Analytics	The operational datasets, data dictionary, cleaning, analysis, and plain-language translation of findings	3_Workflow_B_Operations_and_Analytics

Suggested roles (assign in Week 1)

Role	Count	Owns
Engagement Lead	1	Timeline, board narrative, final integration, Request Log health
Workflow A Lead	1	Issue tree, options, trade-off reflection, Analysis Requests
Research Lead	1	Interview synthesis, credibility matrix, validation
Workflow B Lead	1	Data dictionary, cleaning, Findings Memos, dashboard
Operations Analyst	1	Funding scenarios, cost analysis
Project & Quality Lead	1	Minutes, version control, handoff checklist, file naming

In a team of five, combine Research Lead with Workflow A Lead. Full ways of working (decision rules, free-riding prevention) are also in 4_Shared_Toolkit/Team_Roles_and_Ways_of_Working.pdf.

The A↔B evidence loop

Workflow A does not receive the operational datasets and must not ask facilitators for the file. Workflow B does not push raw tables into A's narrative. Instead the team runs a four-step loop (templates in 4_Shared_Toolkit/Templates/):

Step	Who	What	Template / output
1. Data Estate Brief	B -> A	Catalog of what B holds (tables, grain, coverage, limits in plain language). Not the workbook, not the data dictionary, not field dumps that let A write the analysis.	Data_Estate_Brief.docx -> PDF in A_B_Exchange/
2. Demand Brief	A -> B	Ranked decision needs and hypotheses (what would change the recommendation). Demand, not a shopping list of column names.	Demand_Brief.docx -> PDF in A_B_Exchange/
3. Analysis Plan	B (share summary with A)	B owns how to answer each priority demand: approach, definitions, risks, ETA. A does not co-edit pivots or receive interim raw extracts.	Analysis_Plan.docx -> PDF in A_B_Exchange/
4. Request -> Findings	A then B	Formal Analysis Request (R-xx) and Findings Memo (FM-xx) for each answered demand. This is the assessment trail markers read.	Analysis_Request.docx / Findings_Memo.docx

Before final options, the team must complete at least three Analysis Requests with Findings

Memos returned. Every quantitative claim in A's deliverables must cite a Request ID or Findings Memo. The Data Estate Brief, Demand Brief and Analysis Plan must exist in A_B_Exchange/ before R-01 is treated as complete. Before any gated submission (options, final report, board pack), complete the Cross-Workflow Handoff Checklist - see Section 8.

5. What you will produce - by week

Programme opens Sunday 26 July 2026 and closes Sunday 20 September 2026. Working weeks run Monday to Friday. Weekly submissions are due Friday 17:00 ICT unless a Board or handoff time is stated. Day-by-day detail lives only in GBF_Consulting_Toolkit.xlsx (Master Timeline).

Week	Dates (2026)	Submit by end of week
1	27-31 July	Kickoff; roles confirmed; Project Charter & RACI; Request Log set up; start data-room reading
2	3-7 August	A1 issue tree; A1b stakeholder map; information credibility matrix; B profiling under way (Data Estate Brief draft)
3	10-14 August	B Data Estate Brief (Mon); A Demand Brief (Tue after reading DEB); B Analysis Plan; R-01 filed + FM-01 returned; B1 data quality (B internal); A2 interview synthesis; A3 empathy & journey maps; B2 dashboard v1
4	17-21 August	R-02 and R-03 + FM-02/FM-03 (each with Analysis Plan updates as needed); B3 analysis summary; A4 strategic options (cite R/FM IDs); B4 evidence-check memo
5	24-28 August	A5 trade-off reflection; A6 validation; B5 funding scenarios; A7 revision log; executive summary draft
6	31 Aug-4 Sep	Final report draft for handoff; online handoff checklist confirmed
7	7-11 September	BOARD PRESENTATION Thu 10 Sep 09:00; all final deliverables Fri 11 Sep 17:00
8	14-18 September	Peer evaluation (Mon); reflection journal (Tue); lessons-learned; programme closes Sun 20 Sep

Track the loop on the Request Log tab: R/FM rows plus milestone ticks for Data Estate Brief, Demand Brief and first Analysis Plan. Minimum three completed R/FM pairs before final options.

6. How you will be assessed

A 100-point rubric applies. The table below is the expected scale for planning your effort. Facilitators may refine descriptors or band cut-offs; any change will be announced. Treat these weights as indicative, not a frozen contract.

Criterion	Points (expected)
Problem understanding	15
Research quality	10
Design thinking	15
Data analysis and translation	20
Recommendations	20
Presentation	10
Project management	5
Teamwork and cross-workflow exchange	5

Presentation Day also applies a panel split (Buddy / Core Team / Guest Board). Your Buddy will confirm the live weights at kickoff. Strong teams ask precise questions, translate findings honestly, and own the costs of their preferred recommendation.

7. Citation standard

Every claim must be trackable for markers. Do not cite a document code alone.

Source type	Required citation form	Example
Client document	Ref + section or page heading	D-02 §1 Dong Nai; D-01 'Our year in numbers'
Interview transcript	Transcript code + speaker	BN-02 (Tuan); ST-05 (Minh)
Findings / requests	Request or Findings ID	R-02; FM-03
Dataset (B only, via memo)	Table + field + definition used	employment_outcomes.placed_90d (formal)

8. How you receive the package, work, and submit

Receiving the package

Your Buddy (or programme Core Team) issues the Participants/ folder to your team at kickoff - usually as a Drive share or a ZIP. You do not need to download anything from a public repository. If your folder is incomplete, ask your Buddy before inventing missing files.

Shared workspace

Each team works in the Google Drive / Google Workspace folder created by the programme (or Microsoft 365 if your cohort is assigned that stack). Buddies and Core Team only review files in that folder and via the weekly submission Form. Copy templates from the package into your Drive before editing - keep the issued package as a read-only reference.

File naming (mandatory)

Use: TeamShortName_Owner_DeliverableCode_Version.ext

Example	Meaning
Tiger_All_Charter_v1.pdf	Whole-team Project Charter, version 1
Tiger_WSA_A1_IssueTree_v2.pdf	Workflow A deliverable A1
Tiger_WSB_DEB_v1.pdf	Data Estate Brief (B -> A)
Tiger_WSA_DMD_v1.pdf	Demand Brief (A -> B)
Tiger_WSB_AP01_Plan_v1.pdf	Analysis Plan AP-01 (B)
Tiger_WSA_R01_Request_v1.pdf	Analysis Request R-01 (filed by A)
Tiger_WSB_FM01_Findings_v1.pdf	Findings Memo FM-01 (returned by B)
Tiger_All_Handoff_v1.pdf	Completed Cross-Workflow Handoff Checklist
Tiger_All_BoardDeck_vFinal.pptx	Final board deck

A_B_Exchange folder (mandatory for assessment)

Create a folder in your team Drive named A_B_Exchange. Every official cross-workflow communication must be saved there as PDF using the templates below. Markers and Buddies assess teamwork from this folder - not from chat history.

What	Template location	Who files
Data Estate Brief (DEB)	4_Shared_Toolkit/Templates/Data_Estate_Brief.docx	Workflow B
Demand Brief (DMD)	4_Shared_Toolkit/Templates/Demand_Brief.docx	Workflow A
Analysis Plan (AP-xx)	4_Shared_Toolkit/Templates/Analysis_Plan.docx	Workflow B
Analysis Request (R-xx)	4_Shared_Toolkit/Templates/Analysis_Request.docx	Workflow A
Findings Memo (FM-xx)	4_Shared_Toolkit/Templates/Findings_Memo.docx	Workflow B

1. Export each completed Word template to PDF before filing.
2. Name files with DEB / DMD / AP-xx / R-xx / FM-xx codes.
3. Update the Request Log tab in GBF_Consulting_Toolkit.xlsx whenever a file is added.
4. Informal chat is fine for logistics only. Decisions, asks and answers that affect the

recommendation must appear in A_B_Exchange.

5. Sequence: Data Estate Brief -> Demand Brief -> Analysis Plan -> R-xx -> FM-xx. Minimum three completed R/FM pairs before final options.

Cross-Workflow Handoff Checklist (gate before submission)

Where to find it: 4_Shared_Toolkit/Templates/Cross_Workflow_Handoff_Checklist.docx (also listed in the Submission Checklist tab of GBF_Consulting_Toolkit.xlsx).

When it is required: before submitting strategic options (A4), the final report draft (Week 6), and the final board pack (Week 7). Master Timeline task W6-02 is the formal online confirmation checkpoint (Wed 2 Sep, 12:00 ICT) - do not leave it to the last hour before the Board.

How online confirmation works (no wet signature, no printing):

1. Copy the Word template into your team Drive and fill the checklist boxes ([x] for done).
2. Section A: a Workflow A reviewer confirms Workflow B's Findings quality.
3. Section B: a Workflow B reviewer confirms Workflow A's evidence cites and options.
4. Section C: the Engagement Lead confirms only if A_B_Exchange/ and the Request Log show at least three genuine R/FM pairs (not a last-minute dump).
5. Each confirmer completes the online block at the end of their section: tick [x], type full name, type date (YYYY-MM-DD), and note the channel (e.g. 'Drive file' or 'comment on this Doc').
6. Export the completed checklist to PDF, name it Team_All_Handoff_vN.pdf, save it in your team Drive root (or a /Handoff/ folder), and submit the Drive link via the weekly Google Form when the timeline requires it.
7. Your Buddy checks that the PDF exists and the three confirmation blocks are filled - they do not re-do your quality review.

Submission channel

1. Upload the named file to your team Drive folder.
2. Submit the Drive link (or attach if under size limit) via the programme Google Form for that week - your Buddy will share the Form URL at kickoff.
3. Email is backup only if the Form is down; always CC your Buddy.
4. When submitting options or the final report, include the link to A_B_Exchange and to the completed Handoff Checklist PDF so markers can see the trail.

9. Ground rules

1. Fictional case only: do not treat GBF or named individuals as real; do not bring outside data, news or personal research into deliverables or inferences.
2. Use only the materials in this package.
3. Workflow A must not open or request the raw operational datasets. Route all quantitative needs through Analysis Requests to Workflow B.
4. Workflow B must not share the raw workbook with Workflow A. Share Findings Memos and curated charts only.
5. Official A-B evidence lives only in A_B_Exchange/ using the Data Estate Brief, Demand Brief, Analysis Plan, Request and Findings Memo templates. Chat is not the assessment record.
6. Cite every claim to the citation standard in Section 7.
7. State the definitions you use, especially for the placement rate.
8. Fill templates in Word using Nunito or Lexend (Vietnamese-safe). Present in PowerPoint with the same fonts. Export read-only finals as PDF.
9. Handoff: complete 4_Shared_Toolkit/Templates/Cross_Workflow_Handoff_Checklist.docx with online ticks (typed name + date) - see Guideline Section 8. No wet signature.
10. Your Buddy is a facilitator, not a consultant. They will not give you the answer or the data

file.

10. Package contents

Folder	What is inside
0_Start_Here	This Programme Guideline; data room index
1_Client_Data_Room	GBF documents D-01, D-02, D-03, D-08, D-10, D-11, D-12 and transcripts (no datasets)
2_Workflow_A_Impact_Strategy	Workflow A brief, playbook, A templates
3_Workflow_B_Operations_and_Analytics	Workflow B brief, data dictionary, datasets, dashboard, B templates
4_Shared_Toolkit	Toolkit workbook (Request Log + Submission Checklist), guides, board deck, shared templates including Handoff Checklist